

Timeline: The Missing Transcript and Dismissal of the December 1, 2025 Appeal

Court of Appeals Docket No. 378703 -- Tenisha Hampton v. Gregory Jones -- LC No. 17-163353-DP

This timeline documents what happened after Gregory Jones appealed the December 1, 2025 Wayne County order suspending his parenting time and authorizing law enforcement to retrieve his daughter Maryam. The appeal was dismissed on March 3, 2026 for failure to provide the hearing transcript. This document shows that Gregory made repeated, documented, good-faith efforts to obtain that transcript and to get the Court of Appeals' help when Wayne County did not produce it -- and that the court's dismissal order does not address those efforts.

Timeline

December 1, 2025 -- Wayne County Circuit Court (Hon. Yvonna C. Abraham) holds an evidentiary hearing and issues an Order Following Hearing suspending Gregory's parenting time and authorizing law enforcement to retrieve Maryam Jones from his custody. Gregory did not appear; he was involuntarily hospitalized at the time.

December 16, 2025 -- The Michigan Court of Appeals Clerk's Office sends a deficiency letter on Docket No. 378703 (Hampton v. Jones). It lists several missing items required for Gregory's appeal, including the register of actions, a conforming brief, proof of service, a financial affidavit, and -- critically -- notes that his motion for stay is defective because it lacks a transcript of the stay hearing or the trial court order denying a stay. The letter gives 21 days to cure the defects or face dismissal for lack of jurisdiction.

January 2, 2026 -- Gregory emails Wayne County Circuit Court's transcript department (CivilDomesticTranscripts@3rdcc.org and helpdesk@3rdcc.org) formally requesting the transcript of the December 1, 2025 hearing, explaining that the Court of Appeals has instructed him to provide it or proof it was ordered. Wayne County responds the same day asking him to "submit a case caption" and, after he does, asks him to resubmit with additional formatting. There is no record in Gregory's inbox of Wayne County ever producing the transcript.

January 2, 2026 (same day) -- Gregory also ships a package to the Michigan Court of Appeals via FedEx (tracking no. 887579729455), understood to be his response to the December 16 deficiency letter.

January 5-12, 2026 -- FedEx delays this shipment repeatedly. It was originally due January 5, 2026 and is pushed back day by day through January 12, 2026.

January 13, 2026 -- FedEx reports a “delivery exception” for shipment 887579729455: “We were unable to complete the delivery of your package from Gregory Jones.” No further tracking update appears in Gregory's inbox after this. There is no confirmation this package was ever delivered to the Court of Appeals.

February 9, 2026 -- Gregory prepares a formal “Motion to Compel Transcript or, in the Alternative, for Extension of Time,” addressed to the Court of Appeals on Docket No. 378703. The motion states, on the record: that the Court had ordered him to provide the transcript or a stenographer's certificate under MCR 7.205(B)(4); that he requested the transcript from the Wayne County Circuit Court Clerk's Office on January 2, 2026; and that as of the motion date he had “not received the transcript, nor a stenographer's certificate, nor any formal response regarding the status of the transcript” despite acting in good faith. The motion asks the Court of Appeals to either order the trial court/court reporter to produce the transcript, or grant Gregory an extension of time.

February 13-17, 2026 -- Gregory ships a second package to the Michigan Court of Appeals via FedEx (tracking no. 888760372013).

February 17, 2026 -- FedEx confirms this second package was delivered to the Michigan Court of Appeals at 9:51 AM. This is the most likely delivery of the Motion to Compel Transcript described above.

March 3, 2026 -- Chief Judge Michael F. Gadola, acting under MCR 7.201(B)(3), dismisses Gregory's application for leave to appeal and “all outstanding motions” for failure to pursue the case in conformity with the rules, specifically citing the uncured transcript defect under MCR 7.205(B)(4). The order states that “the defect was not corrected in a timely manner.” The order does not reference, discuss, or rule on the Motion to Compel Transcript that had been delivered to the court more than two weeks earlier, on February 17, 2026.

March 27, 2026 -- On a separate docket (No. 379512, “In re Jones”), Chief Judge Gadola dismisses a complaint for superintending control and motion for immediate consideration for lack of jurisdiction, holding that a direct appeal of the December 1, 2025 order was an available remedy and directing Gregory to file a delayed application for leave to appeal under MCR 7.205.

Why This Matters

The Court of Appeals' March 3, 2026 dismissal frames the outcome as Gregory's failure to comply with the court's rules. The documented record tells a fuller story:

First, Gregory requested the transcript from Wayne County -- the only entity that could produce it -- within days of being told to, and Wayne County's own transcript office responded with procedural back-and-forth rather than the transcript itself. Nothing in Gregory's records shows Wayne County ever delivered it.

Second, Gregory attempted to comply with the Court of Appeals' December 16 deadline by shipping documents on January 2, 2026, the same day he contacted Wayne County. That shipment ran into

repeated FedEx delays and ultimately a delivery exception on January 13, 2026, with no confirmation it ever reached the court.

Third, when the transcript still had not materialized, Gregory did exactly what the court rules contemplate: he filed a Motion to Compel Transcript or, in the Alternative, for Extension of Time, asking the Court of Appeals either to order Wayne County to produce the record or to give him more time because the delay was not his fault. FedEx confirms this reached the Court of Appeals on February 17, 2026 -- two and a half weeks before the case was dismissed.

Fourth, the dismissal order itself is silent on that motion. It does not explain why the motion was denied, was not enough, or was not considered. It simply states the defect was not corrected.

Taken together, this is not a case of a litigant ignoring the court's instructions. It is a case of a self-represented, disabled litigant doing everything the rules asked of him -- requesting the record from the custodian who controlled it, attempting to file a cure package, and then formally asking the court for help when that failed -- only to have his case dismissed without the court addressing his own motion asking for exactly the relief that would have prevented the dismissal.

Documents in This Folder

1 - Court of Appeals Deficiency Letter (Dec 16, 2025).pdf -- the original notice listing the missing transcript and other filing defects.

2 - Court of Appeals Dismissal Order (Mar 3, 2026).pdf -- the order dismissing the appeal for the uncured transcript defect.

3 - Court of Appeals Superintending Control Dismissal (Mar 27, 2026).pdf -- the related order on the separate docket directing Gregory to a delayed application for leave to appeal.

4 - Macomb FOC Recommended Order (Dec 15, 2025).pdf -- a same-week order from the separate Macomb County case (Bilal and Jameel), included for chronological context; it denied Tenisha's motion, not Gregory's.